

FEBRUARY

FEBRUARY 3

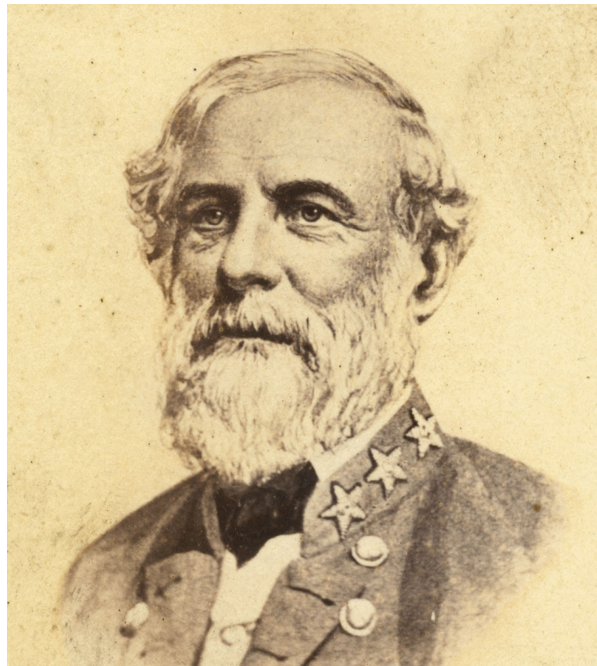
President Lincoln and Secretary of War Edwin M. Stanton meet Confederate commissioners aboard the steamboat *River Queen* for abortive peace talks.

FEBRUARY 5-6

The rival forces entrenched outside Petersburg fight an inconclusive engagement at Hatcher's Run to the south of the city.

FEBRUARY 6

President Jefferson Davis names Robert E. Lee general-in-chief of all Confederate armed forces.



Robert E. Lee

FEBRUARY 17

Sherman's troops take Columbia, capital of South Carolina. That night, much of the city goes up in flames. In North Carolina, Confederate forces evacuate the port of Charleston.

FEBRUARY 22

A Union force under General John M. Schofield occupies Wilmington, North Carolina.

FEBRUARY 23

At Lee's insistence, General Joseph E. Johnston takes command of the Confederate forces facing Sherman's Union army in the Carolinas.